

Colour guide

This directory loosely groups minerals according to their primary colour. Where multiple colours are available, these are listed in the text.



Diamond | See pp.52–57 | Diamond can be colourless, white to black, yellow, pink, red, blue, or brown. It is transparent to opaque with an adamantine lustre.



Quartz (Namibian) | See pp.132–39 | Colourless, yellow, pink, or green, this variety of quartz is transparent to opaque, with a vitreous lustre.



Quartz (rutilated) | See pp.132–39 | Rutilated quartz is colourless with gold, red, or green needles of rutile. It has a vitreous lustre and is transparent.



(Quartz) rock crystal | See pp.132–39 | Naturally occurring in a colourless form only, rock crystal has a vitreous lustre. It is transparent.



Selenite | See p.123 | Selenite can be colourless, white, yellow, or light brown. It is transparent to translucent, with a vitreous or pearly lustre.



Pollucite | See p.185 | Pollucite may be colourless or grey, blue, or violet. It ranges from transparent to opaque, and has a vitreous lustre.



Danburite | See p.246 | Ranging from colourless to yellow, brown, or pink, danburite is transparent with a vitreous lustre.



Celestine | See p.121 | Celestine occurs as colourless, white, red, green, blue, or brown. It is transparent to translucent with a vitreous lustre.



Amblygonite | See p.117 | Amblygonite is colourless, white, yellow, pink, brown, green, or blue. It is transparent with a vitreous or pearly lustre.



Phenakite | See p.282 | Phenakite is colourless, yellowish, pink, or greenish blue, and is either transparent or translucent with a vitreous lustre.



Tourmaline (achroite) | See pp.226–29 | Achroite, a variety of tourmaline, is colourless with a vitreous lustre. It is transparent to translucent or opaque.



Albite | See p.172 | Albite may be colourless, greenish, bluish, or black. With a vitreous or pearly lustre, it ranges from transparent to opaque.



Euclase | See p.283 | With colourless, white, blue, or green varieties, euclase is transparent to translucent and has a vitreous lustre.



Platinum | See pp.44–45 | This precious metal is silver-white in colour. Platinum has a metallic lustre and is opaque.